

Part 1 - Hometown

What kind of place is your hometown?

Student: My hometown is a densely populated city (1) and is located in (1) the north of the country. It is renowned for (2) its bustling (3) city centre and is teeming with (4) people day and night. There is a wide range of shops, it could be described as a shopper's paradise (5), however, it isn't the most picturesque (6) place in the world and is best described (2) as a concrete jungle (7).

What are the most interesting things to do there?

Student: There are loads of great things to do there such as (1) shop till you drop (8), then followed by (2) with afternoon tea in a fancy (9) café and maybe a bit of sightseeing. I would strongly recommend visiting (3) the art gallery. There are a few masterpieces (10) in there so it's definitely worth visiting (4).

What kind of jobs do people do there?

Student: There is a mixture of (11) jobs done (5) by the people who (6) live there. Firstly (3), there is a large industrial estate (12) on the outskirts of (13) the city so many local residents (14) are employed (7) there. In addition (4), because of the increasing number of (15) shops there, a lot of the individuals (16) are employed (7) in the service industry (17).

Would you say it is a good or bad place to live?

Student: Although (5) there are drawbacks (18) of living in such a crowded and busy city (19), I wouldn't want to live anywhere else because there's always something to do. I'm

a massive fan of (20) city living so at this point in my life (21), I wouldn't want to live anywhere else. In the future, the distant future (22), however (6), I might be tempted (23) to relocate (24) to the country because I don't think the city is a place to bring up (25) kids (26).

How do you travel around your hometown?

Student: I generally tend to (27) travel around by bus. The transport network (28) is pretty good (29) and it is reasonably cheap (30). It is also quite reliable (31). Using a car is difficult because of the traffic jams (32) in the rush hour (33) and the city centre can get particularly congested (34).

Would you prefer to live in a bigger or smaller place?

Student: Despite the fact that (7) I can see the pluses (35) of living in a smaller place, such as having clean air to breathe, I absolutely adore (36) living in a city. There is no time to get bored because it literally is the city that never sleeps (37). As I get older though (8), I think I will get sick of (38) the rat race (39) and will end up (40) living in a house in the country.

Part 1 – Town/City Where You Live Now

Where do you live now?

Student: I'm residing (1) in the UK at the moment, in a city called Leeds. I've been living there (2) for the past nine months. It is located in (1) the north of England.

How would you describe the town/city?

Student: Firstly, I would have to say that (1) it looks like quite an industrial city, however (2), I don't know how much industry there is nowadays. Moreover (2), it is most definitely (2) a thriving (3) place, new apartments are being built (3) and there are shopping centres popping up (4) all over the city - both in the heart of the city (5) and on the outskirts (6). It is quite a cosmopolitan (7) area and the fact that there is a university there makes it quite an ethnically diverse place (8) to live.

What do you like about your area of the town/city?

Student: I wouldn't say that (3) it's the most stunningly beautiful (9) place in the world, however the amenities (10) are second-to-none (11). There is everything that I need. For instance (4), there is a wide range of shops, a multitude of (12) restaurants, from upmarket places (13), where it costs an arm and a leg (14) to eat to reasonably priced (15) places where you can get a cheap bite to eat (16). There is a football stadium there, although the team, Leeds United, isn't really worth watching (4) at the moment.

Is there anything you don't like about your area of the town/city?

Student: The thing I'm not keen on about (17) living there is that the transport network isn't that great. There are buses and trains, but it doesn't have trams like other cities such as Manchester, therefore (2), to get around it takes ages (18) and the trains and buses aren't always punctual (19). This is a major issue (20) for me because I need to get to classes on time.

Do you expect to continue living in this town/city for a long time?

Student: That's a tricky question to answer (5) right now because I'm not entirely sure (21) if I will be living (5) in Leeds in the near future (22). I have applied (6) to a number of different universities, one of which is Leeds, however, I could end up (23) in Brighton, which is miles away from Leeds.

Part 1 – Work

Where do you work?

Student: I work as a nurse and **am employed (8)** in a hospital in my hometown.

Do you think it is a good place to work?

Student: **Don't get me wrong (4)**, **I absolutely love (28)** my job, but the equipment in the hospital is quite **dated (29)** and this can make the job hard at times.

Why did you choose this job?

Student: I wanted to work in a **profession (30)** where I could help people. **Furthermore (5)**, I didn't want to do a **desk job (31)**. **I would be bored to tears if I had to do (9) a nine-to-five job (32)**. I like **the variety (33)** in the job I do, no two days are the same,

What do you enjoy most about your job?

Student: **As previously mentioned (6)**, no two days are the same, therefore, boredom is something I don't suffer from in my job. I get to meet **people from all walks of life (34)** and **even though (7)** there are sometimes days when it can be **tough (35)**, often people leave the hospital feeling better so I get **a feeling of satisfaction (36)** that I have helped them.

Have you always wanted to do this job?

Student: When I was younger, I wanted to be a doctor, but the thought of studying for seven years **put me off (37)**. When I left school, I got a job in an office, but I quickly realised that **I wasn't**

cut out for (38) sitting behind a desk all day so that was when I retrained (39) as a nurse. I don't regret it for a second (40).

What training did you need to do for this job?

Student: My training lasted for four years. It was a combination of (41) practical training on the job (42) and study in the classroom. I have learnt most things actually doing the job though. I feel like I am still learning (10) every day because diseases change and new drugs are developed to combat (43) them.

What are your work plans for the future?

Student: I would like to work in the UK so that is why I am taking (10) IELTS in order to meet the requirements to work there. I understand there is a nursing shortage (44) there. It has always been my dream to work in another country. If I get a job there, I will stay there for about a decade (45), then hopefully return to my home country and use the skills I have obtained to get a top job (46) back home.

Part 1 – Study

What do you study?

Student: I'm currently studying (1) on an English course in the UK. I've been studying (2) here for about six months.

Where do you study?

Student: I'm studying (3) in a further education college, which is situated in (4) the south of England.

Do you think this is a good place to study?

Student: Absolutely (1). The college is a massive (2) place with great facilities (3). There's a huge (4) well-stocked (5) library and the science labs are well-equipped (6) with the latest equipment (7). The catering facilities (8) offer a wide variety of food options and there are plenty of places to get a cheap bite to eat (9). I thoroughly enjoy studying there (10) because the teachers are warm, caring and inspiring (11).

Have you always wanted to study this?

Student: Absolutely not (12). When I was younger, like all youngsters (13) I had dreams of becoming famous, but as I grew older I became fascinated by (14) science. My science teacher in secondary school was an inspiration (15) to me and sparked an interest in (16) this subject.

What is the most interesting part of your study?

Student: I particularly enjoy (17) the practical work because it's very hands-on (18) and it is easier to understand things when you actually experience them. Generally (1), we tend to do (5) practical work once a week and theoretical stuff the rest of the time. I wish it was the other way round (19).

Is there anything you don't like about your study?

Student: The only thing that I'm really not keen on (20) about my study is the amount of homework. I'm snowed under with work (21) and it leaves me with very little time to do anything else. I used to like (6) going to the cinema regularly with my mates (22), but since starting (7) this course I spend every spare minute with my head in a book (23).

What are your study plans for the future?

Student: In the near future (2), I hope to go to university in the UK. I have applied to a number of top universities (24). In the longer-term (3), I imagine (25) I will return to my home country and I hope to get a job in the field of (26) environmental science. I'm hoping that my degree and knowledge gained in the UK will enable me to find a good job with good prospects (27).

Did you learn to ride a bike when you were a child?

If I remember rightly*, I'm pretty sure** that I was taught when I was around five or six. I remember falling off a few times, but I can't really recall*** any more details than that.

*If I remember rightly = We use this expression to say that we think that we can remember something correctly, but we are not completely sure.

**I'm pretty sure
= I think

***to recall =
to remember

Is it easy for you to ride a bike in your country?

Definitely not. There are very few cycle lanes and the roads are incredibly busy. The roads are a death trap* to cyclists, to be brutally honest**.

*death trap = a structure or situation that is very dangerous to life

**to be brutally honest = to be very honest

Fluency and Coherence
Grammatical Range and Accuracy
Lexical Resource



What do you think are the benefits of riding a bike as a child?

Well, aside from* the obvious** health benefits, there's a saying 'You can't teach an old dog new tricks', which means it is tricky*** to teach elderly people things so it's better to learn as a child.

*aside from = besides; apart from; in addition to

**obvious = clear; evident

***tricky = difficult



Is it safe to ride a bike on the road?

Absolutely. We have a well-developed cycle network* with bike paths. A lot of money has been invested in the infrastructure** and it is safe and well-organised. Cyclists are very fortunate*** in my country.

*cycle network = a set of cycle routes

**infrastructure = the basic physical and organisational structures and facilities (e.g. buildings, roads, power supplies) needed for the operation of a society or enterprise

***fortunate = lucky

Fluency and Coherence
Grammatical Range and Accuracy
Lexical Resource

Have you ever visited a farm?

I'm pretty sure** that I visited a farm when I was studying in primary school. If I remember rightly*, we made butter or something like that*** and fed some livestock****.



**I'm pretty sure = I think

*If I remember rightly = We use this expression to say that we think that we can remember something correctly, but we are not completely sure.

***something like that = used to refer to things when you're not being specific

****livestock = animals and birds kept on a farm such as cows, sheep, chickens etc

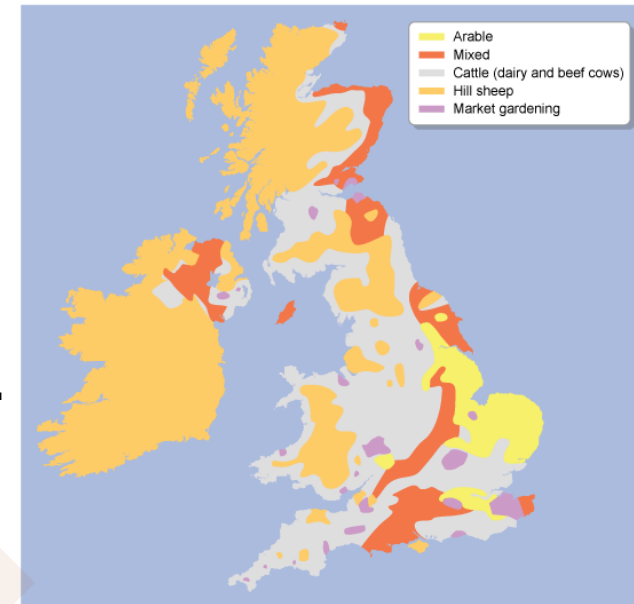
What kinds of farms do you like?

I'm not sure I have a preference*, to be perfectly honest. I eat an awful lot** of bread so I guess arable farms*** would be my favourite, if I had to choose one.

*a preference = one you prefer; one you like more than others

**an awful lot = a LOT; very much

***arable = grow crops



Fluency and Coherence
Grammatical Range and Accuracy
Lexical Resource

Do you think farming is important?

Oh absolutely. We rely on* farms for a variety of products such as dairy**, wheat, veg and suchlike*** so we would be lost without them****.

*to rely on = to depend on

**dairy = milk, cheese etc

***and suchlike = etc; and other similar things

****to be lost without something = to be unable to live/work without something



Did you do farm work when you were young?

Not that I can recall*. I come from an urban area** so it would be tricky to do any agricultural labour. If I had the chance to do it now, I would jump at it*** because I love animals and being out in the open****.

*Not that I can recall =
Not that I can remember

**urban area =
town/city

***to jump at something = to accept an opportunity
that is offered to you in a very enthusiastic way

****to be out in the open =
to be outdoors

Fluency and Coherence
Grammatical Range and Accuracy
Lexical Resource

Did you go on a picnic when you were a child?

From time to time* yeah, we used to go on picnics. We tended to go on bank/public holidays when the sun was shining and my parents wanted to get us out of the house instead of watching TV 24/7.

*from time to time = occasionally; every so often

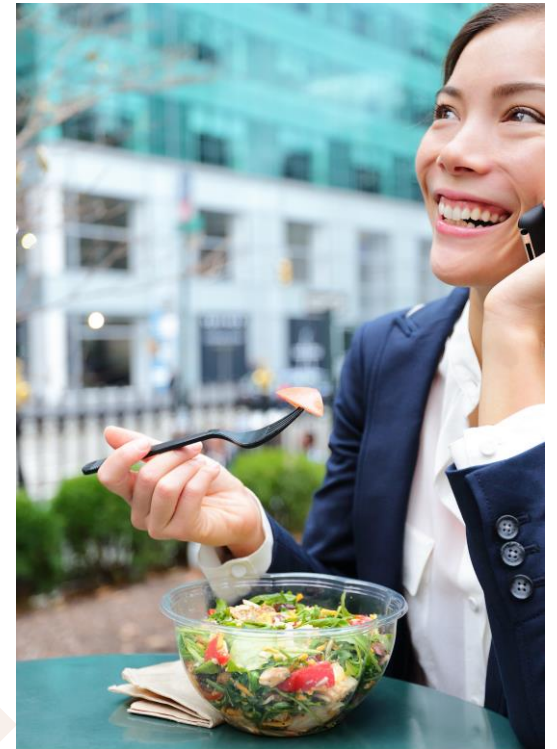
How often do you go on a picnic now?

It's not something I do on a regular basis. I guess at most I go twice a year. Rather than having a picnic, I often buy some food and go and eat it in a park to get some fresh air**. It's kind of like a picnic, but an impromptu*** one.

**to get some fresh air = to go outside

***impromptu = unplanned

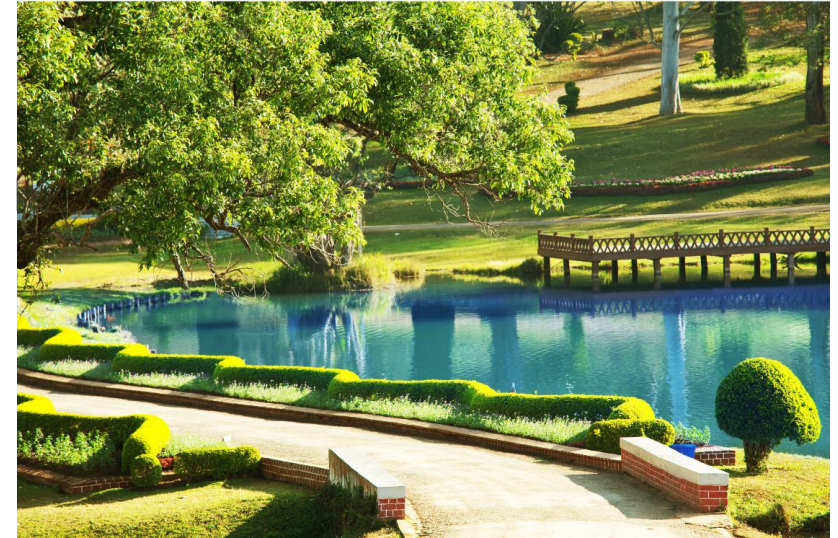
Fluency and Coherence
Grammatical Range and Accuracy
Lexical Resource



Where do you go on a picnic?

There's a **stunningly beautiful** park just round the corner from where work so **I tend to go** there in my **lunch break** **whereas** if **I'm not working**, I go to the beach or somewhere a bit further **afield***.

*afield = away



What is the difference between a picnic and cooking at home?

Picnic food **tends to be finger food** such as **wraps** or pizza whereas when **you're eating** at home, it might be a meal with a knife and fork or chopsticks. Picnic food is **generally** cold **in contrast to** a home-cooked hot meal.



Fluency and Coherence
Grammatical Range and Accuracy
Lexical Resource

Do you like texting?

I wouldn't say it's something I particularly like, but I do like the **convenience** of being able to **fire off*** a text. It's much quicker than any other **means of communication****. I'm not a **pro-texter** though and I don't do **text talk** like **LOL**.

*to fire off a text/an email = to send something very quickly

**means of communication = methods of communication

Do you prefer sending or receiving text messages?

I don't really have a **preference**; **however**, when you get one, **the onus***** is on you to **reply** **whereas** when you send one, you can sit back and relax and wait for the **response**.

***onus = duty, burden, responsibility

Fluency and Coherence
Grammatical Range and Accuracy
Lexical Resource

LoL

bt

np

hru

txt

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H.A.N.D.

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4eva

m8

Prepare for {IELTS}

Have you ever received a confusing text message?

Oh yeah, **on a regular basis**. When my mum texts me, she often **clicks send** before she has finished writing it so I get half a message and **I don't have a clue*** what **she is talking about**. She's not very **tech-savvy****.

*I don't have a clue = I don't know

**tech-savvy = know a lot about modern technology



In what circumstances is making a phone call better than sending a text message?

When **you're in a rush*****. So, for example, if you need **to get hold of someone quickly to pass on****** some information or find out something then **making a quick call is preferable**.

***to be in a rush = to be in a hurry; to not have much time

****to pass on = to tell some information to someone else after you have heard it

Fluency and Coherence
Grammatical Range and Accuracy
Lexical Resource

Do you have a lot of furniture in your home?

My **style** is quite **minimalist*** so I don't have **an awful lot** of furniture. I **can't bear** lots of **clutter**** so I just have **a few key pieces**. It's much easier to keep clean and **I'm a clean freak** so this is why **minimalism** is better for me.

***minimalist** = very simple

****clutter** = lots of things making it look messy/untidy

Has anyone ever bought furniture for you?

Not that I can recall*.** In the past, people **used to give** furniture as wedding presents, but that doesn't happen nowadays and it would be quite **costly** to buy someone a piece of furniture as a birthday gift.

*****to recall** = to remember

Fluency and Coherence
Grammatical Range and Accuracy
Lexical Resource



What kind of furniture would you like to buy?

I've got my eye on* a new sofa, but I've just got a kitten and she is using my current one as a scratching post so that is out of the question** at the moment, I'm afraid.

*to have your eye on = to want

**to be out of the question = not possible



Which piece of furniture in your home do you like best?

Without a shadow of a doubt***, my bed. I love getting into bed. It's incredibly comfy and it feels like a safe haven**** for me. I can switch off from work and just chill out.

***without a shadow of a doubt = we use it when something you are saying is very true

****a safe haven = a safe place

Fluency and Coherence
Grammatical Range and Accuracy
Lexical Resource

Part 1 – Fish

Why do people go fishing?

I'm not entirely sure because it's not something I'm into myself, but I guess they find it relaxing and it's a great way to recharge your batteries*.

*to recharge your batteries = If you recharge your batteries, you take a break from activities which are tiring or difficult in order to relax and feel better when you return to these activities

Do you like eating fish?

Yes, I try to eat fish on a regular basis**, as it's healthier than meat, particularly oily fish such as mackerel and salmon.

**on a regular basis = regularly

Where can you see fish?

Well, it depends on the fish. Some live in the ocean and some in freshwater rivers, but on land the best place to see them is in an aquarium*. A lot of major cities have them.

*aquarium = sea life centre

Where do you buy fish?

Occasionally in the supermarket if **I'm pressed for time****, but I prefer to get them from the market because **they tend to be fresher** and there is **a wider choice available**.

****to be pressed for time = to be in a hurry; to not have much time**

Part 1 – Corona Virus

How do you feel about the corona virus outbreak?

Oh my goodness, we are living in an unreal situation at the moment. I know there were previous pandemics such as the Spanish flu, but this feels unprecedented* - it's a living nightmare. Health professionals are doing an incredible job trying to save people, but hospitals are so overwhelmed** that they cannot cope with the numbers of infected people.

*unprecedented = never done or never known before

**overwhelmed = swamped; flooded

What do people have to do during the quarantine time?

That kind of depends... if you are able to work from home, then you have to still work, mind you, this isn't an option for all. Regardless of*** your work situation, staying sane**** is a priority. Everyone's mental health will be affected during this crisis so it's essential to vary***** your activities during the day and try to do some physical exercise as well.

***regardless of = without being influenced by any other events or conditions; despite

****to stay sane = having a healthy mind

*****to vary = to change

Part 1 – Jeans

Do you wear jeans?

Yes, I do. I think they're probably one of **the most used items of clothing** in my **wardrobe**.

No, I don't. **I used to wear them** when I was younger, but I don't anymore.

How often do you wear jeans?

As often as I can really. They are **my go-to item** so I wear them anytime I can **dress casually**. **I live in them***, **to be perfectly honest**.

***To live in something** means to wear it all the time

Do you like wearing jeans?

Yes, I do because they're **comfy** and **trendy**. **Admittedly**, they're not great to wear in hot weather, but I love wearing them when it's **chilly** because they keep me warm.

Why do you think jeans are popular in your country?

I guess that one of the main reasons is that they come in many different **styles/fits** so there is **a style/fit to suit everyone**. So, if you prefer **tight** trousers/pants, you can wear **skinny** or **slim** jeans, **whereas** if **you are into baggy clothes**, you can wear **regular** or **boot-cut** jeans.

Do you normally stay up late?

I didn't use to stay up late but since being in lockdown I've become a bit of a night owl*. I've been staying up past midnight whereas previously I used to be fast asleep** by half ten.

*a night owl = a person who tends to stay up until late at night, or the early hours of the morning

**to be fast asleep = to be in a deep sleep

When was the last time you stayed up late? Why

Like I said, I've been doing it quite a lot recently, but the last time I pulled an all-nighter was when I was studying for an exam in high school. I couldn't do it now though.

***to pull an all-nighter = to stay up all night usually studying



Fluency and Coherence
Grammatical Range and Accuracy
Lexical Resource

Did you like to stay up late when you were a child?

Well, yes I did, but my parents were pretty strict and stuck to a routine so I had to be in bed early on a school night. In the holidays, they were a bit more chilled* and let me stay up past my bedtime**.

*to stick to a routine = to keep to a routine; to do the same things regularly at the same time

**chilled = relaxed; easy-going

***past my bedtime = past the time you normally go to sleep

Part 1 – Wild Animals

Have you ever seen a wild animal before?

Yes, I have and oh... what an **incredible** experience. When **I was visiting** Australia, **we were driving** down a **pretty isolated** road and suddenly a **kangaroo hopped** in front of the car. **We were going** slowly so stopped the car and just **stared at** this amazing **creature**. **It really took my breath away***.

***to take your breath away** = astonish or shock you, with pleasure, surprise, or some other emotion

Which wild animal do you like the most?

Oh gosh, that's a tricky question because I'm an animal lover so **it's tough to pick just one...** I guess **if I had to choose, I'd go for** the panda. They're **incredibly cute** animals and **endangered**** so it's **virtually impossible***** to see one **in the wild**.

****endangered** = in danger of extinction

*****virtually impossible** = almost impossible

Do you like going to zoos?

Yes and no, it's not something I do **as a rule***; **however**, if I'm on holiday then I might go to a zoo **to pass the time****. I'm not a massive **fan of** keeping animals **in cages** in zoos, **to be perfectly honest; however**, if they have a **breeding programme***** for **endangered species**, then I support that.

***as a rule** = If you say that something happens as a rule, you mean that it usually happens.

****to pass the time** = to let time or a period of time go by especially while doing something enjoyable

*****a breeding programme** = the planned breeding of a group of animals or plants, usually involving at least several individuals and extending over several generations

Part 1 – Museums and Art Galleries

Do you like art?

Art is such a **broad term*** and if it includes **visual, musical and performance art** then yes, I am a massive fan of art. **If you are simply talking about** art as in drawings and paintings, then **I'm not into it** as much. **I'm more of a music lover.**

***a broad term =** includes a wide range of things

Do you have any artwork on your walls?

I have a few **prints****, not **original artworks**. I have one by... oh what's his name, **sorry the name escapes me*****... **anyway**, it's a painting called the scream.

****prints =** an art print is a reproduction of an original artwork

*****if something escapes you =** you can't remember it

Do you like going to museums?

Yes and no, it's not something I do **as a rule***; **however**, if I'm on holiday then **I make a point of going**** to museums because you get **a flavour** of the place.

***as a rule =** If you say that something happens as a rule, you mean that it usually happens.

****to make a point of doing something =** to always do something or take particular care to do something

Have you ever been to an art gallery?

Yes, I have, I've been to a few. Although I wouldn't class myself as** an art enthusiast, I do like Van Gogh so when I was visiting Amsterdam I went to the Van Gogh museum to see his masterpieces. I was blown away****, to be perfectly honest.

***to class = to include someone or something in a particular group because they have similar features or qualities

****to be blown away = to be very impressed by something

Part 1 – Running

Do you like running?

In a word, no. I occasionally have to run for the bus when I've slept in*, but going for a fun for pleasure or to keep fit is not something I do as a rule.

*to sleep in = to sleep later than you normally do

How often do you go for a run?

Never ever**. I'm not a fan of running and, to be perfectly honest, the last time I went for a run was when I was studying in high school.

**never ever = we use this in speaking to make 'never' much stronger

Where do you usually go running?

I only run when I am running late for something such as a bus or a train. I get out of breath* and my knees hurt if I run for long so I try to avoid it.

*to get out of breath = when you have a shortness of breath and are gasping for air after exercising

Do you think running is a good way to stay healthy?

Actually, no I don't. On the plus side, it is aerobic exercise**, which is good for your heart; however, there is a lot of strain*** on the body so you can get a lot of injuries.

**aerobic exercise = aerobic exercise is any type of cardiovascular conditioning or "cardio." During cardiovascular conditioning, your breathing and heart rate increase for a sustained period of time.

***strain = pressure, demands

Part 1 – Science Classes

Do you/did you like science classes?

On the whole, I guess so. The practical lessons when we did experiments were my favourite, but I wasn't as keen on the theory lessons. Obviously, it depended on the topic, some were fascinating whereas others were tedious.

*on the whole = in general

Did you have science classes in primary school or high school?

Both, if my memory serves me right*. In primary school, we did more practical lessons and in secondary there was more emphasis/focus on the theory sadly.

*if my memory serves me right = is a way to say you think you are remembering something correctly

What kind of science did you do at school?

There was a mixture of physics, biology and chemistry. From memory, physics focused on energy, biology included animal and plant ecosystems* and chemistry covered atomic structure and energy changes, that kind of thing.

*ecosystems = an ecosystem is a community of living organisms in conjunction with the non-living components of their environment, interacting as a system.

Do you think science classes are important?

Absolutely, 100% yes. I think some topics are covered in too much depth and it would be better to have a broader, general understanding, particularly of things about the environment and how our actions are damaging it.

Part 1 – Pens and Pencils

Do you usually use a pen or a pencil?

I'd say, nine times out of ten*, I use a pen, but if I was drawing something, then I'd use a pencil because you can rub out/erase any mistakes/errors.

*nine times out of ten = on nearly every occasion; nearly every time

Which do you use more often?

On the whole, I use a pen much more frequently than a pencil because you have to sharpen a pencil so you need a pencil sharpener and I don't always have one with me.

When was the last time you bought a pen or pencil?

Off the top of my head*, I can't honestly remember. I tend to get freebies** when I'm staying in a hotel or in a meeting so I haven't bought one in ages.

*off the top of my head = If you say something off the top of your head, you say it without thinking about it much before you speak, especially because you do not have enough time

**freebies = a thing that is provided or given free of charge

What do you think if someone gives you a gift of a pen or pencil?

Look, it's the thought that counts*** so I appreciate any present I am given. And you can never have too many pens and pencils.

***it's the thought that counts = used to say that you are grateful for a gift from someone even though it is small or unimportant

Part 1 – Laughter

Do you like to watch TV shows or films that make people laugh?

Oh absolutely, yes I do. I'm a huge fan of comedy shows and films.

Life is incredibly hectic and stressful at times so I love to chill out* watching something hilarious.

*to chill out = to relax instead of worrying or feeling anxious

Do you usually make people laugh?

I wouldn't say I'm a comedian but I have a dry sense of humour** and can be quite witty*** at times.

**to have a dry sense of humour = a person with a "dry" sense of humour often says funny things with a serious, calm expression. They don't smile, laugh, or make silly faces

***witty = using words in a funny and intelligent way

Do you think it's important to laugh with your friends?

Yes, without a doubt, this is essential. Because we're all leading such busy lives, you need to be able to let off steam* and having a laugh together is a great way to do that. Laughing releases endorphins**, which are good for you.

*to let off steam = to do or say something that helps you to get rid of strong feelings or energy

**endorphins = chemicals in the body that make you feel good

Part 1 – Numbers

What's your favourite number?

Like **the majority of** people, **I have a preference for** the number 7. I guess **it's considered** the world's luckiest number because there are seven days of the week, seven colours of the **rainbow**, seven seas, seven **continents to name but a few***.

***to name but a few** = used after mentioning a small number of people or things as examples of a larger group

Are you good at remembering phone numbers?

I used to be when we used **landlines**, but now with mobiles, the numbers **are stored** in the phone so there's no need to **memorise** them.

Do you usually use numbers?

Not much **on a daily basis, to be perfectly honest. Because of this, I tend to use a calculator app** on my phone if I need **to work out*** anything. It's a bit **lazy** but it's hard to do **mental maths** when you don't do it often.

***to work out** = to calculate

Are you good at maths?

I used to be when I was studying in secondary school/high school, but I've forgotten most of it. I'm good at **the basics**, I guess, things such as **adding, subtracting, multiplying, dividing...** that kind of thing.

Part 1 – Cake

Do you like cakes and desserts?

Absolutely! I have a sweet tooth and I can't get enough of sugary snacks and sweet stuff. Sadly, they are fattening and I have to watch what I eat and not overindulge*.

*to overindulge = to have too much of something – usually food or drink

What desserts do people in your country like?

At the moment, brownies and cupcakes are all the rage*. Cupcakes, in particular, are a bit hit with* kids because they come in different colours and flavours. They are often served at kids' parties.

*to be all the rage/to be a big hit with = to be popular

Have you ever made a cake?

Yes, a couple of times. I'm not very good at baking to be perfectly honest though because it is more scientific than cooking. You must weigh/measure all the ingredients carefully and I don't have enough patience. I prefer cooking savoury dishes* because you can be a bit more experimental with flavours.

*savoury dishes = not sweet

Part 1 – Voices

Do you enjoy recording your voice and listening to it?

Absolutely not! I can't stand the sound of my voice so this is not something I would do. When I hear it on recordings I actually **cringe!**

***to cringe** = to feel embarrassed about something **cringey** = embarrassing

Has your voice ever changed?

I'm not entirely sure to be honest. I guess it might have got deeper as I've got older. I think it was more **high-pitched** when I was younger, but **I've never really thought about it.**

Are there some people's voices you don't like?

No, I don't think so. When **toddlers are throwing a tantrum*** their screams can be annoying but it's not their voice that's the problem, it's **the high-pitched screaming that gets on my nerves***.

***to throw a tantrum** = to suddenly become angry and behave in an unreasonable way

****to get on your nerves** = to be incredibly annoying

Is your voice similar to your parents?

I guess so because we have the same **accent** so there are a lot of **similarities**. It's more like my mum's than my dad's but that's probably **due to gender**.

Is your voice different from when you were young?

Like most kids, my voice was much higher when I was younger **whereas** now it has **a lower pitch***. **As well as that**, I guess my voice was more **animated/dynamic** when I was a kid and now it tends to be more **monotone**** and flat.

***pitch** = sound/tone

****monotone** = the pitch doesn't change much **monotonous** = boring

Part 1 – Walking

Do you walk a lot?

Not as much as I should, **to be perfectly honest**, but **I've just got** a fitbit **thingy** – like **a walking app tracker** so **I'm trying to walk** more.

Do you walk more often than in the past?

I'd be lying if I said yes. Life is so **hectic** at the moment and I just don't have the time so **rather than walking**, I take the bus or use my car. Living in **the rat race*** means that sadly I think the majority of us **are walking** less nowadays.

***the rat race** means the highly competitive world of work and business

Do you think people will walk more in the future?

No, absolutely not. Everyone is pressed for time* and **we're rushing from A to B** so there's no time to slow down and walk.

It's a sad reality* really.

***to be pressed for time** means to be in a hurry/rush.

***a sad reality** means something that is true and sad e.g. It is a sad reality that today's generation is growing up in a world where mass shootings and killings are **the norm**.

Where do you usually take a walk?

If I can grab five minutes during my lunch break I walk to the park for a bit of fresh air. I need to make time to do it more often though because it's a rare happening/occurrence at the moment.

Part 1 – Languages

How many languages can you speak? What are they?

Including **my mother tongue** I can speak three languages and they are _____, _____ and _____. I'm **by no means*** **fluent** in _____, but **I can get by in it**. **I've only been studying** it for about a year.

***by no means** = not at all; certainly not

Do you think it is difficult to learn a new language?

That depends on the person... **for me, personally, it is becoming tougher/trickier** as I get older. For children, it seems easier because their brains are like **sponges** and **they take in information** much more quickly.

Will you learn a new language in the future?

I hope so... **I'm dying to learn** _____ but **I'm focusing on** English at the moment so it'll be **in the distant future**, I guess.

***To be dying to do something** = to want to do something very much

Part 1 - Friends

1. Do you have many close friends?

I'm not a very **sociable** person, so I don't have **a large circle of friends**. I have quite a number of **acquaintances though**. I am **choosy about** my friends so I have several special **close ones** who **I'd consider friends for life**.

2. What do you usually do with your friends?

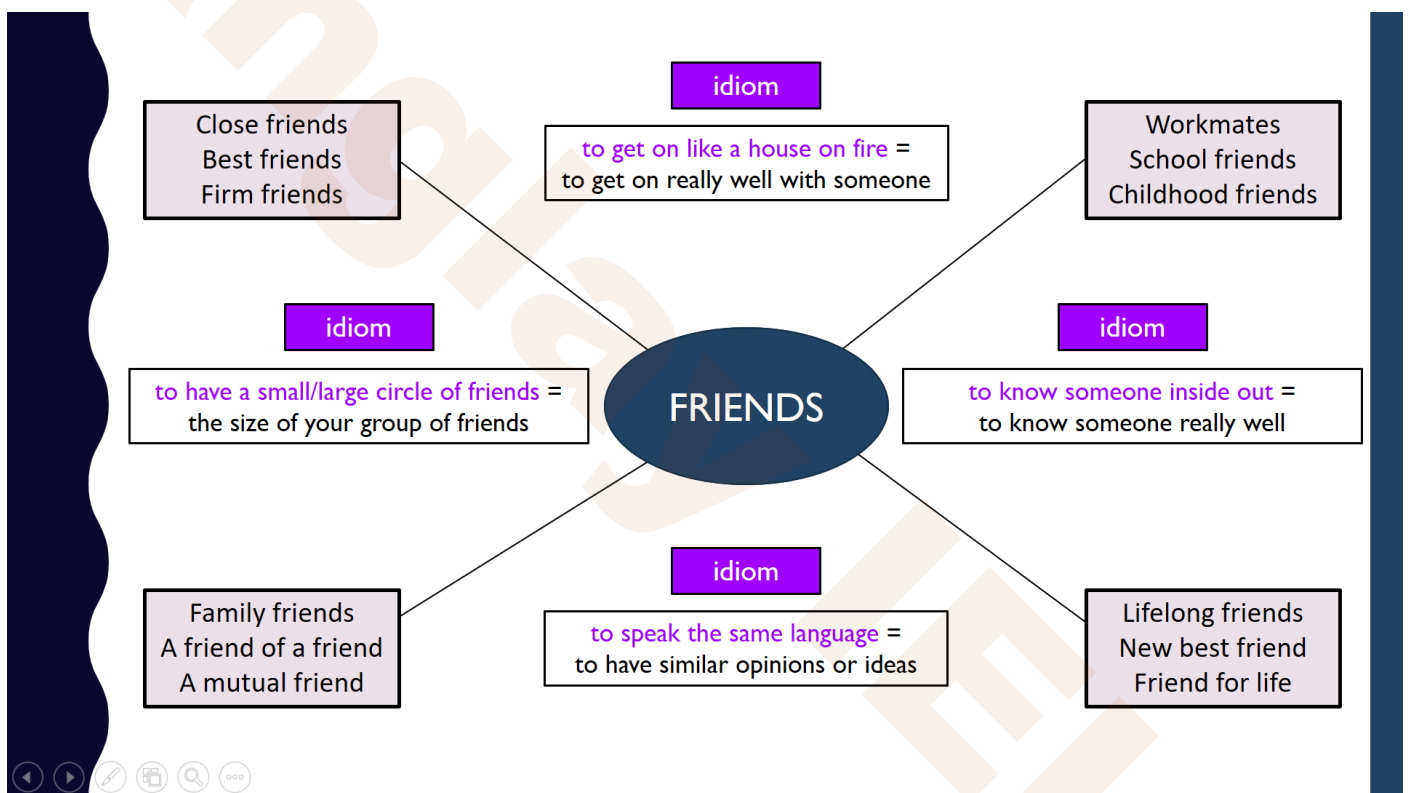
My best friend and I are both **obsessed with** food, so we like eating out in our favourite restaurants and **having a good catch up**. **From time to time**, a group of us **go on a mini break**, which is great because **we all get on like a house on fire** and have a fabulous time.

3. Are you still friends with your friends from primary school?

Oh, yes, absolutely but it is hard and there are a couple that **I have lost touch with**, but **generally** I'm still in touch with most of them. I don't have to see or meet them often to have **a face-to-face chat**, but the **special bond** is always there. I think **the major reason** for this is **we know each other inside out**.

4. Do you like chatting with your friends online?

Without a doubt, yes. Nowadays, **we are all leading such hectic lives** that it's **tricky** to find time **to get together**, but we have a What's app group and **keep in contact** through that.



Part 1 – Tiredness

What things make you tired?

Oh, numerous things such as manual work and mental tasks, but on the whole I guess I feel shattered when I haven't had any caffeine for a few hours. Like most people, I'm addicted to caffeine and if I don't get my fix then I start to feel sleepy.

To get your fix = To get the required or necessary amount of something, especially something you are addicted to

What do you do when you feel tired?

It depends on the time of day and what I'm doing, but I'll have a coffee and the shot of caffeine picks me up. Sometimes I have a power/cat nap if it's possible and that perks me up.

Who do you prefer to talk to when you feel mentally tired, your friends or family?

Nobody, to be perfectly honest. If I'm mentally exhausted I prefer to shut myself off from the world and recharge my batteries by chilling in front of the TV and binge-watching* something.

***To binge-watch =** watch multiple episodes of (a television programme) in rapid succession, typically by means of DVDs or digital streaming

Do you want to talk to strangers when you feel mentally tired?

No, not at all, absolutely not. I'm socially awkward* at the best of times so the last thing I want to do when **I'm dead on my feet*** is **interact with** strangers.

***To be socially awkward** = to not be comfortable with social interaction

***To be dead on your feet** = to be really tired

Part 1 – Concentration

When do you need to concentrate?

Mainly, when I'm working and particularly if I have a deadline to meet then it's crucial that I stay focused and complete the task on time.

What might distract you when you are trying to stay focused?

Absolutely loads of things, for example, social media is a major distraction and checking emails or messages. Sometimes it is my own thoughts though. I'm a procrastinator and that is a major problem* when I'm trying to concentrate because I think 'I can do it later'.

To procrastinate = to delay or postpone action; put off doing something

Procrastination is the thief of time

*I've used major twice, you could use massive/huge instead

What do you do to help you concentrate?

I'd like to say that I **switch off** my phone, close all my social media accounts and **shut out the world**, but **the reality** is that I don't. I'm **guilty of checking** my phone and social media when I should be concentrating.

Is it difficult for you to stay focused on something?

Without a doubt, yes. I'm too easily **distracted** and although I know what I should do to **prevent this happening**, I don't do it so **tasks and chores tend to take me** twice as long because I **get sidetracked** all the time.

To get sidetracked = to have your focus/attention moved to something that is not as important

Part 1 – Hair

What's your favourite hairstyle?

Oh... my favourite hairstyle... That's not something I've ever thought about before, sorry but I don't think I have one. I know what I don't like, I'm not keen on skinheads.

How often do you have your hair cut?

Every six weeks or so, I get a trim to get rid of the split ends and tidy it up. If I have a special occasion such as a wedding then I might go in between that time.

How much do you usually spend on your hair?

Not a lot when I go to the hairdressers/barbers. It's relatively cheap. Mind you, I spend quite a lot on grooming products such as shampoo, conditioner and hair wax.

Do you often change your hairstyle?

No, I tend to stick with the same style. It might fluctuate in length, but it stays pretty much the same. I'm a creature of habit and don't like drastic changes.

Part 1 – Litter/Garbage

Why do some people throw litter/garbage on the street?

The only explanation/reason I can give is laziness. They can't be bothered to* look for a bin or take their rubbish home with them.

What do you do with your litter/garbage?

Well, first of all I look for a bin to put it in but if I can't find one then I take it home with me. I absolutely cannot throw it on the ground, it is not in my nature**.

**be unwilling to make the effort needed to do something

**it is not something I would do

How do you feel when you see people throw litter/garbage?

Oh, this is one of my pet hates. It infuriates/annoys me so much when I see the streets littered with rubbish. It really drives me insane/crazy.

Do you think your city is clean or not?

It's far from perfect, but I've seen dirtier places. There are fines in my country so this keeps it clean to a certain extent, but people still drop litter.

Part 1 – Bags

Do you often use a bag?

Yes, I always **carry** a bag because I need so much **stuff** **such as** phone, purse/wallet, kindle **etc.** I **tend to carry** a lot of **junk*** as well so I have **everything but the kitchen sink** in there.

***junk** = old or useless things that are of little value

What types of bag do you like?

I love **designer bags** and **if I had more money, I would buy one,** but **I can't afford one** so **I tend to buy** a **practical** bag rather than one I like.

Do you have different bags for different occasions?

Yes, I have my **briefcase** for work and **a backpack** that I use when **I'm travelling.** If **I'm going to a special event** **such as** a wedding then I might use **a shoulder or clutch bag** to match **my outfit.**



briefcase



backpack



shoulder bag



man bag



clutch bag

Part 1 – Music

When do you listen to music?

I listen to music at **every possible opportunity** – when **I'm getting ready** for work, when **I'm driving** to work, when **I'm working** – **pretty much all the time**. I use **an app** called Spotify and have lots of different **playlists** that I use **depending on my mood**.

How much time do you spend listening to music each day?

Some days **I guess** it would be as much as 18 hours because I have **background music** on all the time when **I'm working, cooking, cleaning** etc. Other days, if I'm in meetings **or suchlike** it's less, but, **on average**, I'd say **roughly** 12 hours.

What kinds of music do you listen to?

My musical taste has changed recently, **I used to be into western artists**, but nowadays I **mainly** listen to K-Pop. I'm really into **EDM*** and like **up-tempo** songs with catchy lyrics*****

*Electronic Dance Music **music that is cheerful and has a fast tempo ***easy to remember
--

Have you ever been to a concert before?

Yes **I've been** to a few actually. **I was lucky enough** to get tickets to see BTS at Wembley during their **sold-out stadium tour** last month. **It was the best concert I've ever been to** in my life. **Absolutely incredible!**

No, sadly not. There are a few **artists** that I'd love to see such as _____, but **they haven't performed** in my country yet so **I haven't been fortunate** enough to see them.

Part 1 – Perfume

Do you use perfume/aftershave?

Yes, I do. **I tend to use it** every day.

As a rule, I do, but I often forget **to put it on.**

No, I don't unless it's **a special occasion** such as a wedding.

No, never. **I am allergic to** perfume or any strong smells so I avoid it at all times.

What kind of perfume/aftershave do you like?

To be honest, **I don't really have a preference.** I'll wear anything.

Generally, I prefer **citrus/vanilla fragrances.**

What does perfume/aftershave mean to you?

Well, it depends... **if it has been bought for me** by someone special, then it has a special meaning, but if I buy it, **to be perfectly honest,** it has no special meaning, it's just a pleasant smell.

Do you ever give perfume/aftershave as a gift?

It's not something I have ever done because I think it's tricky to buy it for someone else because you don't know what they like or what will suit them.

Yes, I do, but I make sure that I know exactly the brand of perfume/aftershave that the person uses before buying.

Part 1 – Smiling

Do you like to smile?

Absolutely, yes. Whenever I'm feeling happy or if I see something **cute** like a kitten or a puppy, then I smile.

When do people smile at others?

I guess there are a few things that can **trigger a smile**.

Generally/On the whole, it is a sign of happiness; **however, they** can be caused by everything from **anxiety** and **fear** to **satisfaction** and **joy**. Smiles can be **infectious*** so if others are smiling then it makes others smile too.

*likely to spread or influence others quickly

Do you smile when people take photos of you?

Sometimes I do and sometimes I don't. It depends on the photo and **the location** – sometimes it might be **inappropriate** to smile, **but yes, on the whole**, I do.

Can you recognise a fake smile?

Oh yes, totally. When **someone is genuinely smiling**, their eyes are **smiling** too, but if **they are faking it** then you can tell by the eyes.

Part 1 – Crowded Places

What kinds of places are often crowded?

Well, **in major cities, particularly** during **the rush hour**, public transport is always crowded. Buses and trains are **jam-packed** with **commuters** going to work. It is **virtually impossible** to get a seat at such times and, personally, I hate travelling **at peak times**.

When was the last time you were in a crowded place?

Because **I commute** to work/college, then **I am faced with this on a daily basis**. The underground/bus is always **teeming with people** so I am in a **congested** place every day.

How do you feel when you are in a crowded place?

I try not to focus on it because if I think about it then **it stresses me out**. I don't have **claustrophobia*** or **panic attacks***, I'm not that bad, but I certainly don't feel comfortable when I am in an **overcrowded** place.

to have/to suffer from claustrophobia* = to have a fear of small spaces

/ˌklɒːstrəˈfəʊbiə/

to be claustrophobic = to have a fear of small spaces

/klɒːstrəˈfəʊbɪk/

panic attacks* usually last from 5 to 20 minutes. Symptoms can include breathlessness, a racing heartbeat and trembling

Part 1 – Trust

- **Trust (noun)** = strong belief in the reliability, truth, or ability of someone or something
- **Trustworthy (adj.)** = a person you can trust
- **To trust someone/something** = to have faith/confidence in someone/something
- **To put your trust in someone/something** = to give someone/something your trust/belief
- **To lose trust in someone** = to lose your faith/belief in someone/something
- **To gain your trust** = to earn your trust

Who do you trust most?

Close friends and family, **mainly**. I have **a circle of friends** who **I've been friends with** for many years and **I have faith in them** and **trust them implicitly/without question**.

Have you ever lost trust in someone?

Yes, I trusted someone I used to work with, but she stabbed me in the back* – long story, but yes, I've definitely experienced this.

To stab someone in the back = to do something to someone so they/you lose trust in you/them

What kind of people do you trust?

I like to think that most people are trustworthy, but I am cautious when I meet someone new and it takes a while to gain my trust.

Do you trust artificial intelligence?

In a word, no. Like most people, I'm quite *cynical about it. AI is based on processes and I'm not entirely sure the procedures used are 100% reliable.

*To be cynical about something = to be distrustful of something

Part 1 – Water

How often do you drink water?

Not as much as I should **to be perfectly honest**. I think **the recommended daily allowance** is **roughly** three litres, but **I'm guessing** I drink about two litres **at most**. I suffer from a lot of headaches and it's probably because I am **dehydrated**.

What kinds of water do you like to drink?

I'm not **fussy*** and I'll drink anything, but **if I had a choice, I'd pick sparkling water** because I find it more **refreshing**.

Do you drink bottled water or water from water coolers?

If I am at home, **I tend to drink tap water**, but **if I am out and about**, I usually have **bottled water**. If I am somewhere where they have **a water cooler**, I'll use that. I'm not **picky***, as long as it is clean water.

Part 1 – Amusement Park

✓ Do you like going to amusement parks?

Oh yes, absolutely, I love theme parks. I'm a thrill seeker and I love the adrenaline rush*.

✗ Oh no, absolutely not. I'm terrified of heights – I think I suffer from vertigo** so I don't like going on any rides.

How often do you go to amusement parks?

I used to go more when I was younger, but nowadays, not that often because I don't have the time so I only tend to go when I'm on holiday. On top of that, they're quite pricey so I can't afford to go regularly.

*Adrenaline helps your body react more quickly. It makes the heart beat faster, increases blood flow to the brain and muscles, and stimulates the body to make sugar to use for fuel. When adrenaline is released suddenly, it's often referred to as an adrenaline rush.

**Vertigo = a fear of heights

What do you usually do at amusement parks?

Same as everyone else I guess – queue* for hours to get on the rides, pay through the nose* for some greasy food and drink far too many fizzy drinks.

To queue/a queue (UK) OR to wait in line/a line (USA)

To pay through the nose = to pay too much for something

Part 1 – Islands

Have you ever been to an island?

Yes, I have been to an island. I went to _____ a few years back and I'm hoping to go there again at some point, hopefully in the near future.

In the near future = soon

Are there any islands in your country?

Yes, there are. There is the island of _____, just off the east coast of the mainland. It's a stunningly beautiful island and is popular with locals and holidaymakers alike. I've been there quite a few times.

Would you like to live on an island if you had the chance?

Oh absolutely yes, I'd love to. I'd love to retire to an island with plenty of sunshine and just spend my days chilling out and being at one with nature. I cannot wait to escape from the rat race.

To be at one with something = to be very calm and relaxed with something

The rat race = a way of life in modern society, in which people compete with each other for power and money

What do you like to do when you are on an island?

Islands **tend to be** a great place to eat **seafood** so I love going to restaurants and eating the local dishes – the fish is usually **incredibly fresh** and **tasty**.

Part 1 – Social Networks

How often do you use social networks?

Way too much, to be perfectly honest. I'm not a fan of Facebook or Instagram – I have them downloaded on my phone, but it's Twitter that I'm addicted to. I just find it's a great way to keep up-to-date with current affairs, as when news breaks it usually breaks first on the bird app.

Why do you use social networks?

For a couple reasons, I guess. Firstly, to be in the know about what's happening in the world and secondly, because some of the accounts I follow are hilarious, so it helps me to take time out from my hectic lifestyle.

***To be in the know about something = to know what's happening (often when others don't know)**

To take time out = to take a break

What are the disadvantages of social network apps?

Above all, it's the **addictiveness**. You think to yourself 'I'll just take a quick look on Twitter or Facebook' and three hours later **you're still scrolling through** your **feed** and **wasting precious time**.

Do you think it's good to make friends online?

Personally, it's not something I'd do. **Don't get me wrong**, I'm not saying it's a bad thing, but you do need to be **cautious** because not everyone is **trustworthy** and they may not be who they say they are.

Don't get me wrong = don't misunderstand me

Part 1 – Sunshine

Do you like sunshine?

Not as much as I used to. I used to be a sun worshipper, but as I've got older I don't like sunbathing and I get all hot and bothered* in the sun so I prefer chilly days.

*hot and annoyed

What do you do on sunny days?

Well, that depends if I'm working or not. If I'm working, I tend to spend all day moaning 'it's too hot'. If I'm not working, then I stay at home with the air conditioning on full blast. Ideally, I'd go to the beach, but I rarely get the chance.

Do you wear sunscreen?

Oh yes, absolutely. It's foolish not to. It's a must. I wear at least factor 20 all the time and on baking hot days, I wear factor 50. I hate putting it on because it's sticky, but, like I said, it's an absolute must.

Part1 – Morning Routine

What is your morning routine?/What do you do in the mornings?

Well, it depends on the day of the week. **On weekdays**, my alarm goes off at 6.45 and **I immediately hit the snooze button**. Ten minutes later, it goes off again and I get out of bed. After taking a shower, I get dressed, make a coffee and if there's time, I have **a light breakfast**. **On weekends**, **I have a lie in** and get up around 9 and have **a leisurely breakfast**.

Is breakfast important?

Oh, gosh yes, breakfast is the most important meal of the day.

There is **a saying**: eat breakfast like a king, lunch like a prince and dinner like **a pauper**. **Mind you, having said that**, I often **skip breakfast** because **I'm in a rush** and then I start **snacking on** unhealthy foods full of **carbs**, which is really bad for me.

Do you like to get up early in the mornings?

No, absolutely not. I'm not a morning person because I'm a night owl and I tend to burn the midnight oil and stay up too late so I struggle to get up early.

Mornings	Evenings
A morning person	A night person
An early bird	A night owl
An early riser	A late riser
The early bird catches the worm (proverb)	To burn the midnight oil (idiom)

Part 1 – Markets

What do street markets sell?

I guess it depends on the particular market – every one is different, but on the whole they sell everything, for instance, food, clothes, cleaning products and suchlike.

Are there many street markets in your country?

Yes, there are quite a lot actually, particularly food markets. These are becoming increasingly popular nowadays. I love them because there are loads of stalls selling international cuisine and you can try all kinds of food.

What are the differences between supermarkets and markets?

Oh, there are numerous differences but in the main I'd say that food tends to be fresher at markets because you are often buying direct from the producer so you cut out the middleman*.

*a person who buys goods from producers and sells them to retailers or consumers

Do you often go to the supermarket?

Yes I do. To be perfectly honest, I can't stand supermarkets because they're always so busy and the queues at the tills are endless, but it has to be done or we don't eat. I tend to do a big shop once a week, but I still need to pop in during the week to get things I've forgotten or to get fresh milk and suchlike.

Part 1 – Makeup

Do you often wear makeup?

Yes, I do. I don't wear **heavy makeup**, but I **put on foundation, eye shadow, mascara and lipstick** every day.

What does wearing makeup mean to you?

I **guess** it gives me confidence because I feel **naked** without it. I **look washed out** and tired when I don't wear it.

Do you give makeup as gifts?

No, **not as a rule**. It's quite a personal thing so I don't feel comfortable buying it for someone else. **What I tend to do is** give **a gift card** and the person can choose what to buy themselves.

What do you think when you see a man wearing makeup?

I **don't give it a second thought** **to be perfectly honest** because I don't think makeup **should be viewed as** male or female. Many men wear it nowadays and look great. **It's not a big deal***.

It's not a big deal* = it's not important

You can also say: **It's no big deal**

Part 1 – Sky

How often do you look at the sky?

To be perfectly honest, that's not something that I've ever analysed before. I guess I look at it without realising hundreds of times a day, but I probably only consciously look at it when I am looking at it for a particular reason such as if I am going on a day out and I want to know if it is going to rain or not.

Do you prefer the sky in the morning or the sky at night?

Actually, I don't think I have a preference. If it is a bright morning with a clear blue sky then I love the morning sky, but if it is a clear night with not a cloud in the sky then the night sky can be a spectacular sight.

Can you see the moon and stars at night where you live?

Well, it depends on what the weather is like. If it is cloudy or overcast, then obviously not; however, if it is a clear night with no clouds then the moon and stars can be clearly seen.

Is there a good place to look at the sky where you live?

Not that I am aware of because it's not something that I have ever been interested in. I guess that the higher up you are then the view of the sky is better and in rural areas it is probably clearer than in industrialised urban areas where the sky is full of smog.

Part 1 – Teachers

When you were at school did you have a favourite teacher?

Yes, I did actually. It was my German teacher and he was my favourite because he was **passionate about** his subject and **his passion inspired me to learn.**

Would you like to be a teacher?

Oh no, absolutely not. I don't have what it takes to be a teacher.

You need **patience** and I am not that **patient** so I think I would **struggle** to remain calm and not get annoyed by the students when **they are not paying attention or are messing about.**

What kind of teachers do you like?

I prefer teachers who are not too **strict**, but also not too **easy-going** or **laidback**. They need to be interested in what they teach and teach it in a way that is **educational**, but also **entertaining**. That can be hard with subjects such as maths, but it is possible.

Do you think teachers should get angry at students or not?

No, not at all. Oh, mind you, if a student is bullying another student then this is **totally unacceptable**, but they still need **to deal with the bully in a calm way.**

Can you describe a teacher from high school?

My English teacher was a **memorable** teacher because he was **an overweight jolly man** who loved telling stories. **He would tell us** all about when **he was studying** in high school and his stories were **hilarious**.

What's the difference between young and old teachers?

Well, it is easy to **stereotype** here and say that older teachers are more **experienced** and younger teachers are more **energetic** and their lessons are **livelier**. **However, that is not always the case** and it is wrong to compare them in this way.

Part 1 – Money

Did you save money when you were young?

Well, when I was young, I didn't get any **pocket money** so I had no money to save. **When I was studying** in secondary school, I started working in a café at weekends and **I did start saving** then.

Have you ever given money to children?

Yes, when I see my younger **relatives**, **I tend to give them** some money... not much **though**, it's just usually the **loose change** that I have in my pocket.

Do you think parents should teach their children about money?

Oh absolutely yes. If you do not learn about money and understand **the value of money** at a young age then you don't understand how important it is to look after your money.

Nowadays, people are quite **reckless** with money and spend all of their **disposable income** rather than **save for a rainy day**.

Do parents give pocket money in your country?

Some do and some don't. There are some parents who just pay for everything and don't give their kids pocket money each week, **whereas** others give **a fixed amount** and make their children **pay for things out of their own money**.

Part 1 – Colours

What's your favourite colour?

To be perfectly honest, I don't really have a favourite. I do prefer strong primary colours such as red and blue to pastel colours such as pink and purple. I don't have a preference between warm and cool colours – I like both.

Do you like dark colours?

Yes, I do. Many consider black to be depressing, but I think it is a stylish colour and I dress in black the majority of the time. I know that wearing black in hot countries is considered to be bad because black absorbs heat; however, it is actually the best colour to wear and has been proven to keep you cooler.

Are there any colours you dislike?

Well, I'm not a fan of yellow. I don't have a problem with the colour itself – it is a bright warm colour, but it doesn't look good on me. I look ill when I wear it so I avoid wearing it.

Do you usually wear clothes in your favourite colour?

It would be fair to say that after the age of ten we stop having favourite colours, but I tend to wear clothes in the colours that suit me so the majority of the clothes in my wardrobe are black.

Part 1 – Sunglasses

Do you like to wear sunglasses?

Yes and no. When **the sun is shining**, then I wear them because if you don't you start **squinting** and that isn't good for your eyes; **however**, if I wear them for **a long period of time**, **I tend to get** headaches.

Where can you buy sunglasses?

They are **pretty much** available everywhere, **for example**, in the supermarket, clothes shops, airport shops etc. If you need **prescription sunglasses** though, you need to go to **the opticians**.

Do people in your country wear sunglasses?

Oh yes, you see them all the time. Many young people even wear them when **the sun isn't shining**. They have become **a fashion accessory**, not just something you wear **to protect your eyes**.

Part 1 - Writing

Do you write?

Well, I write everyday stuff, but I'm not a writer if that's what you're asking.

What type of things do you write?

Like I said, I'm not into writing prose or poetry, therefore, the majority of writing that I tend to do is notetaking in meetings at work, emails etc. Sadly, nowadays, my writing outside of work is limited to text messages.

Do you prefer to type or write things down using a pen and paper?

Regrettably, handwriting is becoming a dying art because of our overreliance on computers; however, it is so much easier to use a computer because it can be easily rewritten or changed. Obviously, things such as birthday cards need to be handwritten because they need the personal touch.

Part 1 – Parks and Gardens

Are public parks very important in your country?

Well, in urban areas, yes, I would say that they play a vital role; however, in rural areas, they are not as essential. In major cities such as London, there are a vast number of public spaces and they are frequented* by locals and holidaymakers alike*.

rural areas
agricultural areas



urban areas
urbanised areas

frequented* = visited

alike* = used after referring to two groups of people or things to show that both groups are included:

The government and the general public alike need to address the issue of climate change.

Fluency and Coherence
Grammatical Range and Accuracy
Lexical Resource

Prepare for {IELTS}

Do you think there are enough public gardens or parks in your hometown?

I'm currently living in a remote rural location, therefore, there are no public areas such as these, as there is no need for them.

My house is surrounded by fields and I feel very fortunate because I think I would struggle in a built-up area*.

A built-up area* is an area such as a town or city which has a lot of buildings in it



Because I'm living in such a densely populated city*, there are nowhere near enough public spaces for the size of the population. Sadly, I do not see this situation changing in the near future because of the lack of space to create them.

a densely populated city* = lots of people live there

Fluency and Coherence
Grammatical Range and Accuracy
Lexical Resource

Prepare for {IELTS}

What are the benefits of having public parks and gardens?

The main benefit is that they are public spaces that anyone can use. In urbanised areas, there is such a lack of space that many people are living in apartments and, therefore, they don't have their own gardens. On top of that, it is said that city parks improve our physical and mental health, strengthen our communities, and make our cities and neighbourhoods more attractive places to live and work.



Fluency and Coherence
Grammatical Range and Accuracy
Lexical Resource

Prepare for {IELTS}

Part 1 – Space Travel

Would you like to travel to outer space?

Oh my goodness, that's not something I've ever considered before.

My initial reaction is no. It's certainly not something on my bucket list.

What would you do if you had that opportunity?

If I was given this opportunity, I would politely decline. I'm not a lover of flying so going in a rocket would be totally out of my comfort zone.

Do you think it's necessary to see other planets?

Oooh, that's a tough one... I guess it's necessary for scientists to explore other planets; however, I don't think they should become tourist attractions.

Do you like travelling by plane?

As I've said, I have a fear of flying so I only tend to do it if necessary such as long-haul flights to America. I would never use a domestic flight, I'd go by car or train.

Part 1 – Shoes

How often do you buy shoes?

Not that often, to be honest. I have a friend who is **a shopaholic** and seems to buy **a new pair** every time she goes out, but I only buy them when the ones **I am wearing wear out**.

Have you ever bought shoes online?

I am a massive fan of online shopping because of the **ease** and **convenience**, **but interestingly**, shoes are one of the few things I have never bought because it is **tricky** to get the right size and you would have **to send them back**. It is much easier to try them on in a shop to make sure that they **fit perfectly**.

Do you know anyone who likes to buy a lot of shoes?

Yes, my best friend **is addicted to** buying shoes. When she finds **a pair** she likes, she will buy them in **several** colours. I think this is a bit **excessive** and **a waste of money**.

What is your favourite type of shoes?

I prefer **casual** shoes such as **trainers** or **flip flops** to **smart** shoes. I find smart shoes rather **uncomfortable** so I only wear them to work or **on special occasions** and the rest of the time, I wear **comfy** shoes.

Part 1 – Paintings

What do you know about paintings?

Well, I'm not really into art, but I know about famous artists such as Van Gogh and Rembrandt. If I had to choose a favourite artist, then it would be Van Gogh.

Have you ever learned to draw or paint?

When I was studying in school, we had lessons in art, but to be honest I didn't pay much attention. I'm not an artistic or creative person.

Is it important to hang pictures at home?

To make a house feel like a home, I feel that you need something on the wall such as paintings or photos. Personally, I have more photos than artworks and these remind me of family holidays or events that we have been to so I get a warm feeling inside when looking at them.

What kind of paintings do you like?

I prefer portraits to still life or landscapes. But like I said though, art's not really my thing so I would rather look at photos.

If someone wanted to draw or paint a picture of you, would you agree?

Gosh, that's not something I've ever thought about before because I've never been asked... Probably not, because I'm not that keen on seeing myself in photos so I wouldn't want to see myself in a painting or drawing either.

Part 1 - Maps

Do you often use maps?

Thinking about it, I tend to use them more nowadays than **I used to** in the past. **Previously,** you needed to use **a paper-based one,** which was not **practical** or **portable,** **whereas** now you can just use **an app** on your phone such as Google maps.

Did anyone teach you how to use a map?

Not that I can recall. I did study geography at school, but I don't actually remember lessons being about maps, **instead** they were about **earthquakes** and **flooding** and **such like.** **However, I do know** how to read a map. I could be **self-taught** or maybe someone **did teach** me and **I've forgotten.**

Do you prefer paper maps or electronic ones?

Without a doubt, electronic ones. Paper-based ones are either too **detailed** or not detailed enough, **whereas** with an electronic one, you **can zoom in or out** to have it the size you need. Electronic maps make life **incredibly easy** because all you need is a Wi-Fi connection and you have the map you need **at your fingertips.**

To have a good sense of direction

To have no sense of direction

Part 1 – Mathematics

Do you think mathematics is important?

Absolutely... mind you, I don't think **most of the maths** that is **taught** in schools is **practical** or useful. Knowing how to **calculate interest** is far more important than ***trigonometry**.

***trigonometry** = the study of the relationship between side lengths and angles of triangles

Do you think it is difficult to study mathematics?

That depends on the person... for me, personally, I was **pretty average** at it at school. **Some** find it easy and **others** find it **tricky**. I guess it depends on the individual's **strengths and weaknesses**.

Are girls generally good at mathematics?

I feel that ***the general consensus** is that they aren't because **fewer** go on to study it at university; **however**, studies **have shown** that **this is not the case**. In my country, there is **a big push** to get more girls into studying ****STEM** subjects in **higher education**.

***the general consensus** = the majority of people

****STEM** = Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics

Do you often use a calculator?

I'm ashamed to admit that I use one far more than I should. Years ago, when **I was working** in a shop, **my mental arithmetic** was **incredibly** fast, but because I don't do it as much as **I used to** my brain isn't **razor-sharp** anymore so I need a calculator, **I'm afraid**.

Part 1 – Sharing

Have you shared anything with others recently?

Well, when we eat, both at home or in a restaurant, we often share food. I prefer meals like this because then you get to taste everything rather than having an individual **dish** with just one **flavour**.

Did your parents teach you to share when you were a child?

Oh, absolutely, yes. All parents need to do this. **Children go through a stage/a phase** when they want to keep everything to themselves and they do not want to share so parents need to **encourage** them to share. I don't think it is because kids are **greedy**, they just haven't learned **the value of sharing**.

What kinds of things do you like to share with others?

Food, **obviously**, is the main thing. **Having said that though, I am not keen on** sharing puddings. It **annoys** me when the person I am with says 'I don't want a pudding' and then when my pudding arrives, they want to try it.

What kinds of things are not suitable for sharing?

Well, if someone is ill, with a cold, **for instance**, then food and drink **should not be shared**, as **the germs** can pass from one person to another. **Gossip** is another thing that **should not be passed on**. **Sadly**, in these days of social media, **gossip spreads like wildfire**.

Families

How often do you spend time with your family?

Not as often as I'd like I'm afraid. **Although** I would describe us as a close-knit family, we don't get to spend an awful lot of time together. However, when we do get together we have quality time and time to catch up on what we've all been doing.

How do you spend time with your family?

Nowadays, **despite coming** from a close-knit family, we don't have much time to spend together because we are all busy working. **However**, we often get together with our extended family at New Year and have a family meal. **Although** we don't see each other frequently, we all get on like a house on fire.

Do you want to live with your family in the future?

Don't get me wrong, I love my family, but no, **I need my personal space**. Because I don't get much time at home **due to** work, when I am there, I love to have some **me-time**. **During this time**, I'll either read a book or have a long relaxing bath. I do feel a bit **guilty** when I am **chilling out** doing nothing, but I think it's **vital to take time out** and relax. **If I lived with my family, we would probably get on each other's nerves!**

Part 1 – Tea and Coffee

Do people like to drink tea or coffee in your country?

Tea has always been drunk in my country and in recent years the number of those drinking coffee has shot up. Drinking coffee is particularly popular with the young and most teens and people in their twenties can be seen with a disposable coffee cup in their hands.

Do you prepare tea and coffee for guests who come to your home?

Oh, absolutely, yes. It is a custom in my country that whenever a guest comes to your house, you offer them a hot drink. I'm not good at making tea so I always hope that they want coffee because my tea tastes disgusting.

When was the last time you drank tea or coffee?

This morning. My morning routine is that I have a cup of tea as soon as I wake up because I find it more refreshing than coffee.

Then about an hour after that I have a coffee. I find that the caffeine wakes me up so I needed a strong coffee before coming here today.

Part 1 - Dictionaries

How often do you use a dictionary?

To be perfectly honest, I can't recall the last time I used one. I tend to use google translate on my phone rather than a dictionary.

What kinds of dictionary have you used before?

Well, when I was studying in high school, I used to use a paper-based one because phones were prohibited. Since buying a phone, I've been using google translate rather than an actual book.

How will dictionaries change in the future?

In the very near future, I guess that paper-based dictionaries will become a thing of the past. We are living in an electronic world and spend most of our lives on one electronic gadget or another so we have access to online dictionaries, which will result in paper ones becoming obsolete.

Do you prefer a paper dictionary or an electronic one?

For **ease** and **convenience**, **I have to say** that electronic ones are better. Small paper dictionaries have **a limited number of** words and larger ones are **bulky** and not **portable**, **whereas** electronic ones are **handy** because they're available wherever you have internet access.

How would you feel if somebody gave you a dictionary as a gift?

I suppose, on the one hand, I'd find it **a rather odd present** to receive, as, **like I said**, they are quite **dated** nowadays. **However, I am currently learning** Korean, **therefore, if I was given one**, I'd think it was **a thoughtful present** **because the person would be trying to help me** with my studies.

Part 1 - Gifts

How often do you buy gifts?

Well, in my country we **celebrate** birthdays and Christmas and **on both of these occasions** we give presents to **close friends** and family. **Generally**, there is someone's birthday every month and I am an **incredibly organised** person, **a bit OCD to be honest**, so my Christmas shopping starts as early as August.

Do you like giving expensive gifts?

That depends on the recipient of the gift. If it is something for my children, **I tend to purchase quite pricey** items. The problem is that kids, **particularly** teens, **are desperate for** the latest gadgets and these **cost a fortune**.

What kinds of gifts do people often give in your country?

Nowadays, due to the fact that many people have all the things they need, **the majority of** presents that **are given these days** are **gift cards** or money. **In the case of** teenagers, it is **incredibly tricky** to find something **unique** that they don't already have so it's easier to let them choose their own gifts.

Why do people give gifts?

Mmmm, that's an interesting question... I guess on the one hand, they give them to please the recipient of the gift, but I suppose it could be argued that gift-giving makes the giver feel good as well, therefore, there is a selfish aspect to giving presents to others.

Part 1 – Newspapers

How often do you read newspapers?

Student: How often do I read newspapers? (1) Well (2), that depends (1) on what you mean by 'newspapers'. If you mean a newspaper, which is made out of (2) paper, and is tangible (1), then hardly ever (2), however (3), if you mean online newspapers then I tend to (3) read them (3) numerous (4) times a day. I find real newspapers are out-of-date (5) by the time you buy them, therefore (3), I ceased (6) buying (4) them (3) several (7) years ago.

Which is more important where you live: local or national newspapers?

Student: Now, that's an interesting question that I haven't really given much thought to before (4) because I haven't purchased (8) one for many years, but if I had to say, then it would be local newspapers (5). The local newspapers are generally published (6) once a week and are filled (7) with local news, which unlike (9) national news, doesn't date (10) as quickly.

Are newspapers important in your country?

Student: As I'm not an avid newspaper reader (11), it's hard to say (5), but I guess (12) they're not as important as they used to be in the past. Because we have 24 hour rolling news (13), it is possible to access (14) the news online or on 24 hour news programmes anytime day or night, therefore (3), they are certainly not as crucial (15) as they used to be (8). In the olden days (16), when we didn't use to have (9) the internet, then you would see people on public transport reading newspapers, however (3), in contemporary society (17), we are all glued to (18) our phones and electronic gadgets (19).

Do you think newspapers will be more or less important in the future?

Student: I reckon (12) that because newspapers have been in decline (20) over the course of (21) the last decade, then this trend (22) is likely to (23) continue. I imagine (12) the day will come (24) when newspapers are obsolete (25) and the only place to see them is in museums. They will be a relic (26) of a past life and future generations (27) will never know what it feels like to get print (28) all over your hands.

Part 1 – Computers

Why do you think computers and computer games have become more important over the last few decades?

Student: Oh (1), there are a number of reasons why (2) they have become (1) increasingly more important (1) in recent years (2) and the major one (3) is the rapid (4) development in IT equipment. When they were first invented (2), they were massive (5) pieces of kit (6) about the size of a garage (7), whereas (3) now it is possible to have a computer in your watch. This portability (8), for me (9), has been the key factor (10) in their popularity (11) and usage (12).

How important are computers in our lives now?

Student: Without a shadow of a doubt (4), they are incredibly (13) important. It wouldn't be an exaggeration (14) to say that they are probably indispensable (15), however (5), having said that (16), if you asked me if I like computers, I'd say (3) for the most part (17), I do, but I do feel (4) that they control our lives nowadays and sometimes slow us down.

When buying (5) anything, there is so much tapping (18) on a computer whereas (3) in the past it was a quick transaction (19). In addition (6), I'm not keen on the fact that (20) computers make us always available. If somebody sends you an email, they want a reply with the issue dealt with almost immediately.

Are there any bad points about computers and computer games?

Student: Absolutely (7). As previously mentioned (21), there are the issues of people being able to contact you at all times of day and night (22), moreover (8) there are a multitude

of (23) issues brought about (24) by computer games. Firstly (9), they are incredibly (25)addictive (26) and this means that youngsters (27) and teenagers (27) do not want to spend outside doing outdoor pursuits (28) and instead spend all their time playing computer games. Additionally (10), playing online games can expose (29) children to swear words, inappropriate content (30) or worst of all, pedophiles (31).

How influential is the internet on our daily lives?

Student: It is enormously (32) influential. Personally (11), I don't think I go more than an hour without checking the internet. For people like me who are living (6) abroad, it is useful for keeping in touch with my friends and family. In the past, it used to (7) cost an astronomical amount (33) of money to communicate with people in foreign climes (34), whereas (3) now we can do it through email, skype etc without costing a fortune (35).

Part 1 – Freetime

Do you have any hobbies or interests?

Student: I'm glad you've asked me about this (1) because there are a number of things that I do in my spare time (1). Firstly (2), I enjoy doing (1) sport. I take part in various (2) different activities such as football and going to the gym. I particularly enjoy (3) playing football because I get the opportunity to hang out with (4) my mates (5) and play in a team. I love the feeling of being part of a team and all working together towards the same goal of winning the match. Working out (6) is a much different activity because it is quite a solitary (7) activity, but what I love most about it is the opportunity to spend time on my own. Secondly (3), I'm a big fan of (8) going to the movies. This gives me chance to catch up with (9) friends and see the latest films (10) as well. Finally (4), I'm keen on (11) visiting new places. Every month, I try to have a mini break (12) and visit somewhere new.

How do you usually spend your free time?

Student: When I was living in my home country, I used to (2) spend a lot of my free time studying because the school system is very different. We used to (3) have to go to classes on Saturdays so that only left Sundays, which were filled (4) with homework and spending some time with my parents and siblings (13). In the UK, however (5), I tend to (5) have more free time and so I get the opportunity to do much more such as socialising (14) with friends, exploring new places and chilling out (15).

Are there any hobbies that you would like to have in the future?

Student: Absolutely (6). There are a multitude of (16) things that I'd love to do, but time and money prevent me from doing (17) at the moment. Firstly (2), I'd love to learn how to play the piano. I'm not particularly (18) musical (19), but would love to learn how to play an instrument. Secondly (3), I'd like to learn how to speak Italian. I can get by in (20) the language, but I'd like to immerse myself in (21) it and become fluent (22). And finally (4), I'd like to learn how to cook. I'm a real foodie (23), but I'm not a proficient (24) cook so when I have more time, I'll learn how to make bread and pastries.

Do you think hobbies should be relaxing or should they be exciting?

Student: That's an interesting question, I've never really considered before (7), I guess (25) a combination of both (26). You need relaxing hobbies to help you to recharge your batteries (27) after the stress of study or work, however, exciting hobbies are important too because you need to challenge and push yourself otherwise life can become dull (28) and samey (29).

Part 1 – Transport

How do you like to travel when making long trips?

Student: That's a tricky question because (1) on the one hand (2), I absolutely detest (1) flying, however (3), on the other hand (2), if it is a long trip that I have to make then it is by far (2) the most convenient (1). I'd much rather (3) travel by car or by ferry. When you are travelling (2) by car, you get the opportunity to see wonderful scenery (4). Nonetheless (4), the downside (5) of this mode of transport (6) is that if there is heavy traffic (7), then you are likely to get delayed. Being stuck (3) in a traffic jam can lead to road rage (8) and is extremely (9) stressful.

In your country, what kind of transport is used for long trips?

Student: The majority of (10) people tend to use (4) airplanes when taking long distance trips. In actual fact (5), it is often cheaper to fly long haul (11) than take a domestic flight (12). The roads are in a terrible state of disrepair (13) in my country, therefore (3), travelling by car is not ideal (14).

How has transport changed in your country over the last twenty years?

Student: There are a number of ways (6) in which transport has changed in the last two decades (15). Firstly (3), the number of cars on the road has increased exponentially (16), therefore (3), the amount of (5) congestion (17) on the roads has mushroomed (18). Furthermore (3), the cost of the fares (19) of long haul (11) flights has decreased significantly. The growth of budget airlines (20) has led to an increase in the number of

flights **being taken** (6) because it is more **affordable** (21) than before.

What do you think will happen to the transport network in your country in the future?

That's an interesting question. **In the short term** (7), I **reckon** (22) nothing because the government does not have enough money to focus on transport issues, however, **in the long term** (7), something will have to change because the situation cannot continue as it is. There is the **massive** (23) environmental impact of having **a nation** (24) **teeming with** (25) cars. Policies **need to be introduced** (7) to limit the number of vehicles on the road, **nevertheless** (8), I cannot see that happening anytime **in the near future** (9).

Part 1 – Travel

What was the last trip you made?

Student: The last trip I made... (1) that would be (1) a trip I made (2) to America last year. It had always been (3) a lifelong dream (1) of mine to visit Disneyworld in Florida and last year my family and I had (2) a once in a lifetime trip (2) there. Over the course of (3) two weeks, we visited (2) the major (4) tourist attractions in the state (5) and the highlight (6) of the trip was (2) when we went (2) to Clearwater Bay, which is located in (7) the south of Florida, and we saw (2) wild dolphins swimming in the sea. It is something that I will never forget!

What do you enjoy about travelling?

Student: There are loads of things (2) that I love about travelling. Firstly (3), I like getting away from it all (8). We all need time away from our every day life to chill out (9) or you could say 'chillax (10)'. Spending time away from mundane (11) jobs such as cleaning, washing and ironing leaves you feeling energised (12). Secondly (3), I am keen on (13) finding (4) out about different cultures and sampling (14) the foods of different countries. Finally (3), I am a sun worshipper (15) so I love the opportunity to sunbathe (16) and spend a few hours reading some chick lit (17).

Do you ever read books, magazines or newspaper articles about travelling?

Student: Not as a rule (18), however (4), if I am planning (5) a trip, then I will certainly spend some time checking out (19) articles for recommendations of what to do whilst I am away. I'm not much of (20) a sightseer (21), but I do enjoy finding good places to eat so I will try and make a list

of potential (22) places prior to (23) my trip.

Why do you think it is a good idea for young people to travel?

Student: There are a number of reasons why (5) it is essential (24) that the younger generation (25) should spend time travelling. The first reason (6) is that travel broadens the mind (26). Exposure to (27) different cultures can give you a different outlook on (28) life. Another reason (7) is that if we have experienced different cultures and met people of different races (29), we are more likely to be tolerant of (30) our foreign counterparts (31). Finally, it is fun to see the world and try different things because when you settle down (32) and have children, it becomes nigh on impossible (33) to do this.

Part 1 – Festivals

Describe the main festivals celebrated in your country.

Student: There are quite a few festivals which (1) are celebrated (1) in my country and the major ones (1) are Christmas, New Year and Easter. The main one out of these (2) is Christmas and it is renowned for being (2) a day filled with food, fun and presents. New Year is popular with the younger generation (3) and is a time when parties are held (3) to celebrate the new year. Finally (2), Easter, which is a festival commemorating (4) the resurrection (5) of Christ, is a four day weekend in which gargantuan (6) amounts of chocolate are consumed (4).

What do you like about these festivals?

Student: There are numerous things I love about (3) such occasions (7), however (4), the major (8) thing would have to be the food. I know I should (5) probably say it is a time when families come together, but I am a food lover (9) and a chocoholic (10), therefore (4), for me the main attraction (11) is definitely the food. It is a wonderful opportunity to pig out (12) and eat loads of not necessarily (13) nutritious (14), but tasty (15) food.

Have these festivals changed much over recent years?

Student: I guess (16) the key (17) change is that they have become less about religion and more about families regrouping (18) and spending time together. Our lives are so busy nowadays and we're all rushing around like headless chickens (19) for most of the year so it does provide (6) a great opportunity for people to get together and spend time with their loved ones (20).

Do you think they will change much in the future?

Student: I suppose (21) in the near future (22) they will continue to become less about religion, but who knows (23), in the distant future (24), because as a society we are becoming (7) so work-obsessed (25), they might even disappear. Personally, I believe (26) that would be a shame (27) because I look forward to all our festivals and feel that we need them to stay sane (28).

Part 1 – Clothes

Are clothes important to people where you live?

Student: That's an interesting question, but to be honest it's one I've never thought about before (1). I imagine (1) it depends on (1) the age group. For youngsters (2) under the age of 10, I guess not (3), likewise (4) for senior citizens (5), generally (6) I don't believe (7) that they are too bothered about (8) what they wear, however (2), teenagers (9) are probably the age group which is most keen on (2) fashion. I think the major reason (10) for this is peer pressure (11). If your friends are wearing (3) the latest fashion trends (12), then naturally (13) there is pressure on you to be seen in the latest gear (14).

How do people decide which clothes to buy?

Student: That depends on what kind of person you are. If you are a dedicated follower of fashion (15), then what you wear is determined by (16) what is 'in fashion' (17). However (2), clothes might be purchased (4) for work reasons. For example (3), if you work in an office, then you might be obliged to (5) wear a suit. Finally (4), there might be practical reasons for buying certain items (18) such as if you do manual work (19), you need clothes that are hard-wearing (20).

Would you ever buy clothes for somebody as a present?

Student: Definitely not (5). Clothes are personal and you could easily offend (21) someone by buying them clothes. What if you bought something and it was too big, they might think you are suggesting they are fat. I'd say buying clothes for others is a definite no-no (22). The only time I'd

buy something for someone would be if I was (6) very close to that person and I knew their size.

Do you think clothes are too important for some people?

Student: As previously mentioned (6), peer pressure (11) is a key factor (23) why clothes

are vital (24) for some. If you were wearing (7) something that was considered (8) untrendy (25),

then you would stick out like a sore thumb (26) and might get teased (27) or picked on (28).

Clothes can also be used (9) to make a statement (29). If you are in a job where you are judged by

your appearance (30) then the right outfit is essential (31) to make the right impression (32).

The END